

A DIFFERENT KIND OF HACKING

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN GEEKS DECIDE TO CHEAT

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It isn't just our intellect that separates us from the beasts – apes are smart and exhibit problem solving

skills, and some birds are even able to use tools just like us. Humans are only truly defined by their unique ability to think out of the box. We may lack fangs or claws and come naked and otherwise defenseless into the world, but we have managed to cheat the seemingly insurmountable odds and survive as a species – all thanks to our big brains and the ability to think laterally.

It's quite evident that we as a species cannot be bound by rules; much less by those set by fellow humans. That's also why we have a tendency to cheat in everything ranging from something as benign as videogames to matters of graver ramifications such as medical and engineering exams. It's also no surprise that geeks are prolific cheaters – they have big brains and can think laterally.

WINNING WITH BOTS

The highly competitive world of videogames is no exception to this rule. When the prize pool at international e-sports tournaments runs into millions of dollars, it's not surprising to find

enterprising geeks cheating their way to victory. This is exactly what happened when several big-name professional gamers were found using aimbots and map hacks for an unfair edge in the 2014 *DreamHack CS:GO* tournament. The application of bots also extends to games that aren't as competitive. RPGs such as *World of Warcraft*, *Elder Scrolls Online*, *Diablo III*, or any other games that require quite a bit of grinding for attaining gold or experience points, are common targets for wily geeks employing script bots. There are also cases where gamers have rigged up servo-motor equipped contraptions to controllers and created real-world robots to grind their way to high levels in online games such as *Destiny*.

Cheating isn't just reserved for games either. Vancouver-based devel-

oper Justin Long, T Machine is a Tinder bot that employs a sophisticated algorithm incorporating facial recognition technology to select the best match for you. You train it with the first 60 swipes, and then it takes over while you can go do other things, such as cheat in games.

MECHANICAL DOPING

Real-world competitive sports such as cycling don't remain untouched by cheats either. Rumoured to exist for years, mechanical doping is a term used to describe professional cyclists using cycles rigged with electric motors that can generate anywhere between 60 to 250 watts of extra power. This is a considerable advantage when you consider the fact that an average Tour de France competitor can only generate anywhere between 350 to 400 watts on technical climbs anyway.

Mechanical doping was finally confirmed early this year, when a motor was discovered within the frame of a cycle raced by a Dutch cyclist expected to win the Cyclo-Cross World Championships. The governing bodies have now adopted a host of gadgets and electromagnetic sensors to try and catch cheaters, but human ingenuity ensures that cheaters stay a step ahead. They are now allegedly experimenting with electromagnetic wheels. These wheels employ magnets



Why grind for levels/items in games when you can let the Auto-punch Bro do the dirty work for you?